TEACH IN FIVE MINUTES

read aloud - seven steps, then two short demonstrations

1. The goal (30 seconds)

"Diocletian has retired and the throne is empty. You will collect gear, win friends, and try to crown yourself. The first claim that your three rivals fail to stop wins the game."

2. Moving (30 seconds)

"On your turn, roll two dice and move up to the total along the white circles. Streets only - the hatched blocks are buildings. Stop anywhere. Then do one thing. That is a whole turn."

3. Equipment (45 seconds)

"The double circles A to F each hide one piece of gear. Stop on one and reveal it; mark it on your sheet. The more you hold, the stronger you fight: three items make you +1, all six make you +2, forever. Nobody can take them from you."

4. Prestige (60 seconds)

"This coin symbol is Prestige - political clout. Earn it at a star space: stop there, roll one die, 4 or higher pays 1. Win a duel: also 1. You can hold three. You will spend it on friends and on fights."

5. Factions (45 seconds)

"Three groups can back you: the Army at F, the officials at the crossing, the elites at A. Walk to their meeting place and pay 1 Prestige - that faction now supports you for the rest of the game. Get two different factions behind you."

6. The endgame (60 seconds)

"When someone holds all six items they claim at the crossing - the Peristyle - and the succession begins: one more round, then the race to the throne. Stand at the Peristyle with two supporters and proclaim. Now each rival gets one turn to stop you: move next to you, pay 1 Prestige, and duel. Win the duel and the claim dies. Survive all three and you are emperor."

7. Start (15 seconds)

"Random gates, random start, start moves clockwise each round. Youngest player rolls first if you like. Let's play."

Two tiny demonstrations

Ordinary turn: roll 8, walk eight circles to a star, roll one die - a 5 - and take a Prestige. Done.

Claim response: a rival proclaims at the Peristyle. On your turn, move next to them, put 1 Prestige aside (the fee), say 'with boost' and put a second aside if you want +2, then each roll one die and add your item bonuses. Higher total wins; ties to the challenger.

Answer everything else when it comes up. Rare cases live in the rulebook, not in the introduction.